

THE AI-POWERED REAL ESTATE WRITING SYSTEM

Write listing copy that stops the scroll, moves buyers, and closes faster — in 90 seconds flat.

LISTWORKS · LISTWORKS.IO

Full Outline & Table of Contents

Draft v0.2

POSITIONING BRIEF

Title: The AI-Powered Real Estate Writing System **Subtitle:** How Top Agents Write Listings That Sell in 90 Seconds — and How You Can Too
Price: \$20 **Feel:** \$200. Premium. Surgical. Zero filler. **Target buyer:** Agents who would rather show ten houses than write one description — which is nearly all of them. **Core promise:** You will never stare at a blank MLS field again. Not once. Not ever.

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The example set: 1. The suburban 3/2 that reads like every other 3/2 → rebuilt around a lifestyle narrative 2. The small condo with “cozy” problems → reframed as urban freedom 3. The luxury listing that listed everything and sold nothing → rewritten for status and rarity 4. The fixer-upper that scared buyers off → reframed as opportunity copy 5. The new construction with zero personality → given a neighborhood story 6. The dated ranch with “good bones” → rewritten with pride and proof 7. The investment property pitched to the wrong buyer → reframed for ROI buyers 8. The open house description nobody read → turned into an event invitation 9. The social caption that got 2 likes → rebuilt for engagement 10. The email blast that felt like spam → rewritten to feel personal and useful

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Bonus 3 — The Banned Words List *The 40 phrases quietly killing your listings — with replacements* - “Spacious” → name what fits in the space - “Must see!” → tell them what they’ll see - “Updated kitchen” → name the update and what it changes - “Cozy” → own it or reframe it - “Motivated seller” → never. Ever.

CLOSING

You Now Have an Unfair Advantage The transformation, restated. The invitation to keep it going. **CTA:** Ready to never write listing copy yourself again? → **ListWorks, \$49/month**

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PRODUCTION NOTES

Element	Count
Chapters	10 + Bonus section
Before/After examples	10
Prompt templates	15+
Printable tools	5
Estimated page count	60-80 pages
Estimated read time	2-3 hours
Tone	Confident, direct, zero fluff

Next: Draft Chapter 1, then Chapter 5 — the 90-second workflow carries the highest perceived value and should be finished early.

CHAPTER 1

Buyers Don't Buy Houses. They Buy Feelings.

The psychology behind every listing that sells fast — and every one that doesn't.

Here's something your MLS board will never tell you:

Nobody has ever bought a house.

They bought the backyard where their kids finally run wild. They bought the version of themselves who hosts dinner parties in that kitchen. They bought the quiet Sunday morning on that specific porch — coffee in hand, the world not yet awake.

The house was the delivery mechanism. The feeling was the purchase.

This is the single most important truth in real estate writing, and almost nobody operates on it. Most listing descriptions read like spec sheets: bedrooms, bathrooms, square footage, "updated kitchen," "new roof." A breathless inventory of *what* the buyer gets that says nothing about *why they should care*.

Buyers don't decide with spreadsheets. They decide with their gut — then build the spreadsheet to justify the decision they've already made.

Your copy talks to the gut first, or it doesn't work at all.

The 3-Second Scroll Test

Let's establish what you're actually up against.

When a buyer opens a listing on Zillow, Realtor.com, or the MLS, they are not reading. They are *scanning*. The thumb is moving. They make a subconscious go/no-go call in under three seconds based on the photos — and only if the photos pass do they glance at your description.

That glance lasts maybe five seconds. If your first sentence doesn't land, they're gone — and they're not coming back.

You don't get a second chance at a first impression. You get a first *sentence*.

Most first sentences look like this:

“Welcome to this beautiful 4-bedroom, 3-bathroom home in the heart of [neighborhood]!”

That sentence communicates exactly one thing: the person who wrote it wasn't trying.

“Beautiful” is the most exhausted adjective in real estate. “Welcome to” is a verbal throat-clear. “In the heart of” means nothing. And leading with the bedroom count repeats information the buyer already saw in the search filter. Five seconds spent. Nothing said.

Here's what five seconds of real copy does instead:

“The kind of home you describe to people who weren’t there — wide-plank floors, a kitchen that actually fits two people, and a backyard that makes you wonder why you ever thought a condo was enough.”

Same house. Different universe. One of these stops the scroll. The other accelerates it.

Why Features Don’t Sell Homes

Features are facts. Facts don’t move people.

Think about the last major purchase you made — a car, a sofa, a vacation. Did you choose it from the spec sheet? Or did you choose it because of how it made you feel, then use the specs to confirm you weren’t being irrational?

Real estate is no different. Buyers experience your listing emotionally first and rationalize it second.

The problem: most agents write for the rational brain. Facts feel safe and defensible. “3,200 square feet” is objective. “A home that finally has room for everything” is subjective — and subjective feels risky.

But risky is where sales live.

Feature-First	Feeling-First
“Open floor plan”	“The layout that makes parties feel effortless”
“Large master suite”	“A bedroom that actually feels like a retreat”
“Updated kitchen”	“A kitchen where you’ll actually want to cook”
“Mature trees in backyard”	“Shade in summer, color in fall, privacy year-round”
“Quiet street”	“The kind of block where neighbors still wave”

Notice the feeling-first versions aren’t dishonest — they’re *evocative*. They take the same fact and translate it into an experience. That translation is the entire job of real estate copy.

The Feature → Benefit → Feeling Framework

This is the engine behind every piece of copy in this guide. Internalize it once and you’ll never write a flat listing again.

- **Feature** — what the property has
- **Benefit** — what that feature does for the buyer
- **Feeling** — how that benefit makes the buyer feel

Most agents stop at Feature. Some make it to Benefit. The best — and rarest — drive it all the way to Feeling. Every time.

Example 1: The Garage

- **Feature:** 2-car garage with extra storage
- **Benefit:** Both cars, plus the bikes, tools, and gear — nothing living in the living room
- **Feeling:** The version of your life where everything has a place

"A two-car garage with enough room left over that your bikes, your tools, and your holiday decorations all have a home — and none of them are living in your living room."

Example 2: The Kitchen

- **Feature:** Quartz countertops, gas range, large island
- **Benefit:** Real cooking space — a kitchen that works *with* you, not around you
- **Feeling:** The confidence of finally having the right kitchen

"Quartz counters, a gas range that means business, and an island big enough for prep, homework, and a glass of wine at the end of a long day. This is the kitchen you've been compromising away from."

Example 3: The Backyard

- **Feature:** Fenced backyard, mature landscaping, patio
- **Benefit:** Private outdoor space, ready on day one — no projects, no waiting
- **Feeling:** Permission to exhale

"The backyard is already done — fenced, landscaped, with a patio that's begging for a table and some chairs. No weekend projects. Just outside, whenever you want it."

Run this drill on every feature before you write a single word of copy. Three questions, in sequence:

1. What does this do?
2. What does it mean for *this* buyer's life?
3. How does it make them feel?

The answer to question 3 is your copy.

The 4 Emotional Triggers That Move Buyers to Act

Every buyer walking a listing — physically or digitally — is running an unconscious checklist. Not of features. Of *feelings*.

There are four core emotional triggers in residential real estate. Write toward them deliberately and your listings will outperform the market — consistently.

Trigger 1: Belonging

"I can see my life here."

The most powerful trigger in residential real estate. It activates when the buyer can visualize *inhabiting* the space — not visiting it.

Belonging runs on specific, concrete detail. Not “great for entertaining” but “the kitchen where people end up even when dinner’s in the other room.” Not “family-friendly” but “the neighborhood where kids still ride bikes until the streetlights come on.”

Specificity creates believability. Believability creates connection. Connection creates belonging.

In copy: > *“The kind of house that gets called home about three minutes after you walk in.”* > *“A street where you’ll know your neighbors’ names within a week — and be glad you do.”* > *“The dining room where holidays actually happen.”*

Trigger 2: Status

“This is who I want to be.”

Every home purchase is an identity purchase. Buyers aren’t just choosing a property — they’re choosing the version of themselves who lives there.

Status doesn’t mean luxury. A first-time buyer achieving ownership is a status move. A family upsizing into a better school district is a status move. An empty-nester trading square footage for design is a status move.

Status copy speaks to aspiration without pretension. It shows the buyer the elevated version of their life.

In copy: > *“The kind of address that answers the question before you finish asking it.”* > *“A home that does the work of explaining you — before anyone’s even inside.”* > *“For the buyer who’s done compromising.”*

Trigger 3: Safety

“This is a smart decision.”

Buying a home is terrifying. It’s the largest financial decision most people will ever make, and the emotional brain knows it. Safety copy quiets the fear by making the buyer feel intelligent — not impulsive.

This isn’t about security systems. It’s about making the choice feel smart and *defensible* — something they’d proudly explain to skeptical family.

Safety copy leads with substance: location, value, condition, demand.

In copy: > *“In a market where inventory is tight, this one won’t wait.”* > *“A neighborhood where values have held — and then some.”* > *“Updated mechanicals, newer roof, nothing waiting to surprise you.”* > *“The kind of buy that feels smart on day one and smarter every year after.”*

Trigger 4: Urgency

"I could lose this."

Loss aversion is one of the strongest forces in human psychology — people fight harder to avoid losing something than to gain something of equal value. Urgency copy activates it by creating a *credible* sense that waiting means missing out.

The key word is credible. "Won't last!" is noise; buyers learned to ignore it years ago. Real urgency is specific and grounded: the location, the condition, the market, the uniqueness.

In copy: > *"Properties on this street average 4 days on market. This one won't rewrite that trend."* > *"Turnkey homes in this price range are rare. This is the one people wait for — and then kick themselves when it's gone."* > *"There is exactly one of these. Act accordingly."*

Matching Triggers to Buyer Type

Not every trigger works on every buyer. Effective listing copy starts by identifying the likely buyer — then leading with the trigger that speaks to *them*.

Buyer Type	Primary Trigger	Secondary Trigger
First-time buyer	Safety	Belonging
Young family	Belonging	Safety
Move-up buyer	Status	Belonging
Luxury buyer	Status	Urgency
Downsizer	Belonging	Safety
Investor	Safety	Urgency
Relocation buyer	Belonging	Safety

Chapter 3 goes deep on each profile. For now, the rule: **know your buyer before you write your first word**. The same property, marketed to different buyers, demands completely different emotional framing.

The Language Audit

Before writing any listing — or right now, on your last three — run this audit:

Red flags (feature-first thinking): - Does the first sentence start with "Welcome to"? - Do you use "spacious," "cozy," "updated," or "must see"? - Do you lead with bedroom and bathroom counts? - Does any sentence state what something *is* without saying what it *means*? - Could this description be copy-pasted onto any other listing without anyone noticing?

Green flags (feeling-first thinking): - Does the first sentence stop the scroll? - Can the buyer see themselves inside this copy? - Is every major feature translated into a benefit and a feeling? - Does the copy activate at least one of the four triggers? - Is there anything in here that's true of *only this property*?

If you're checking red flags — don't rewrite yet. Keep reading. By the end of this guide, feeling-first writing will be automatic.

Chapter Summary

- Buyers decide emotionally and rationalize with logic. Write for emotion first.
- You have one sentence to stop the scroll. Spend it deliberately.
- Features don't sell homes. The feelings features create sell homes.
- Run **Feature** → **Benefit** → **Feeling** on every element before you write.
- The four triggers: **Belonging, Status, Safety, Urgency.**
- Match the trigger to the buyer before you write a word.

Coming up in Chapter 2: You know what to make buyers feel. Now: the structure that delivers that feeling from the first sentence to the last — and what separates the 3-day sales from the 90-day sits.

— End of Chapter 1 —

CHAPTER 2

The Anatomy of a High-Converting Listing

What separates the 3-day sales from the 90-day sits

Two listings. Same price point. Same neighborhood. Same market.

One goes under contract in 72 hours with multiple offers. The other sits for six weeks, takes a price cut, and closes below ask — to a buyer who negotiated hard because they smelled desperation.

The difference is almost never the property. It's almost always the copy.

Most agents treat the listing description as a formality — something to fill in after the photos upload. The pros treat it as a sales tool. The gap in outcomes between those two approaches is not small, and it compounds across every listing you'll ever take.

This chapter is a master class in structure: the five parts of a high-converting listing, the specific job each part performs, and exactly how to execute each one. By the end, you'll have a framework that works on any property, at any price point, in any market.

The 5-Part Listing Structure That Works Every Time

A great listing description isn't a collection of sentences. It's a sequence — a deliberate progression that moves a buyer from curiosity to conviction.

1. **The Opening Hook** — stops the scroll, earns the read
2. **The Lifestyle Paragraph** — sells the life, not the specs
3. **The Feature Translation Layer** — converts specs into desire
4. **The Neighborhood & Context** — places the buyer in the world of this home
5. **The Call to Action** — creates urgency without begging

Each section has exactly one job. Know the job, and you can write toward it. Don't, and you'll fill the space with adjectives — and adjectives don't close deals.

Part 1: The Opening Hook

Your One Job in the First Sentence

You have about five seconds before a buyer moves on. The hook is where you spend them.

Your one job in the first sentence is *not* to describe the house. It's to make the buyer feel something that makes them want the next sentence. That's it. Don't add more.

The most common mistake: leading with information instead of feeling. Information is what the buyer came for. Feeling is what stops them.

Bad Opens vs. Great Opens

✗ **Bad:** > *"Welcome to this stunning 4-bedroom, 3-bath home in desirable Maple Creek!"*

What went wrong: - "Welcome to" is filler that signals low effort - "Stunning" is the most overused word in real estate - The bedroom count repeats the search filter - "Desirable" is a claim without proof — every neighborhood is "desirable" in its own listing

✗ **Bad:** > *"Don't miss this beautiful move-in ready home with updated kitchen and open floor plan!"*

What went wrong: - "Don't miss" is panic energy, not urgency - "Beautiful," "updated," and "open floor plan" are the three most generic phrases in residential real estate - Zero image created in the buyer's mind

✓ **Great:** > *"Three years ago, the sellers almost didn't put in an offer — the commute felt like a stretch. Now they'd tell you it's the best decision they ever made."*

Why it works: it tells a story, raises a question ("what changed?"), creates social proof without sounding corporate, and contains zero clichés.

✓ **Great:** > *"The kind of home you describe to people who weren't there — wide-plank floors, a kitchen that actually fits two people, and a backyard that finally ends the 'we need more space' conversation."*

Why it works: specific, concrete detail; activates Belonging from the first clause; the buyer can see themselves in it.

✓ **Great:** > *“This house does that thing where it feels bigger every time you walk in.”*

Why it works: short, confident, sensory. It creates an experience before the buyer ever visits — and implies quality without naming it.

The rule for great openers: make the buyer feel something before you tell them anything.

Part 2: The Lifestyle Paragraph

Painting the Life, Not the Property

If the hook is the doorbell, the lifestyle paragraph is the view from the front porch. This is where you sell the *experience* of living in the home — not its components.

Most agents skip it entirely, jumping from a generic opener into a feature dump. That’s a missed opportunity worth thousands of dollars per listing.

The lifestyle paragraph does what no feature list can: it gives the buyer a **day-in-the-life preview**. It makes the purchase feel real before they’ve scheduled a showing.

✗ **Without it (feature dump):** > *“This 4-bed, 3-bath home features an open floor plan, updated kitchen with quartz countertops, primary suite with walk-in closet, finished basement, and two-car garage.”*

That tells the buyer what the house *is*. Nothing about what it’s like to *live there*.

✓ **With it:** > *“Morning starts in the kitchen — real coffee, real light, the kind of open layout where no one gets stuck in a corner. Kids eat at the island while you finish getting ready. By 8 a.m., everyone’s out the door without a collision. After school, the basement becomes its own world. Come evening, the back patio earns its keep — string lights, dinner outside, the kind of yard that makes you forget you have neighbors. This is what the square footage is actually for.”*

Same house. Completely different picture.

How to Write One

1. **Picture your buyer.** Young family? Downsizing couple? Remote worker? The life you paint depends entirely on who you’re painting it for.
2. **Walk through a specific day.** Morning routine, after school, evenings, weekends. Pick two or three moments this property makes *better*.
3. **Use concrete sensory detail.** Not “great natural light” — “morning light through east-facing windows.” Not “peaceful” — “quiet enough that the birds wake you before the alarm.”
4. **Don’t name the rooms.** “The living room is spacious” is a feature. “The kind of room where everyone ends up even when dinner’s in the other room” is a feeling.

Three to five sentences, maximum. You're painting a scene, not writing a novel.

Part 3: The Feature Translation Layer

Making Specs Sound Desirable

This is where the FBF framework from Chapter 1 does its heavy lifting.

Every home has features. Most listings just list them. A high-converting listing *translates* them — turning specs into the desires those specs actually fulfill.

The principle: buyers don't want a quartz countertop. They want to cook without cringing. The countertop is the mechanism. The desire is the real product.

The FBF Reminder

Step	Question	Example
Feature	What does the property have?	9-foot ceilings
Benefit	What does it do for the buyer?	Every room feels larger than it measures
Feeling	How does that make them feel?	The quiet confidence of a home that doesn't feel like a compromise

Copy from the Feeling: > *"Nine-foot ceilings throughout — every room breathes. It's the difference between a home that feels like enough and one that feels like more than you expected."*

Before/After: Translation in Action

Before (feature dump): > *"Home features 3 bedrooms, 2 full baths, hardwood floors, gas fireplace, detached 2-car garage, partially fenced yard, and new HVAC installed in 2022."*

What the buyer hears: a list.

After (FBF applied): > *"Three bedrooms, each with room for real furniture. The primary gets the morning light. Hardwood floors throughout — no carpet, no guessing what's underneath. The gas fireplace means you can have a fire on a Tuesday without making it a whole thing. Out back, a two-car garage with space left over for the bikes, the tools, and whatever you've been meaning to organize. New HVAC in 2022, so the first thing you replace won't be the mechanicals."*

Same facts. Completely different reading experience.

Translation by Category

The translations agents most commonly get wrong:

Raw Feature	Translated Version
"Open floor plan"	"The layout that makes gatherings feel effortless — no one stuck in the kitchen while everyone else is in the living room"
"Updated kitchen"	"A kitchen clearly designed by someone who actually cooks"
"New roof (2023)"	"One less conversation with your insurance agent"
"Finished basement"	"A floor plan that expands when you need it to"
"Walk-in closet"	"Enough room to have a system — and actually use it"
"Corner lot"	"More yard, more light, and no neighbor on one side"
"Cul-de-sac location"	"The street kids can ride bikes on without you holding your breath"
"Original hardwood floors"	"Floors that cost more to replicate than the house cost to build"

You don't need to translate every feature. Prioritize the three to five that will land hardest with your target buyer — then let the secondary features live in one brief, tight list.

Part 4: The Neighborhood & Context

Placing the Buyer in the World of This Home

People don't just buy a house. They buy a **life radius**.

Where's Saturday coffee? How long is the commute? Are the schools good? Will they know their neighbors? The neighborhood section answers these in the language of experience, not data.

Most agents treat this as an afterthought — a tacked-on sentence at the end. But for the right buyer, neighborhood context is the deciding factor.

✗ Weak: > *"Conveniently located near shopping, restaurants, and top-rated schools."*

That sentence applies to roughly 70% of all listings. It does nothing.

✓ **Strong:** > *"Half a mile to the farmers market on Saturdays, four blocks to the elementary school, and a seven-minute highway on-ramp that doesn't feel like a compromise. The neighbors have been here long enough to know each other's names — and new enough that there's room for yours."*

This version places the buyer *in* the neighborhood, living it, not reading about it.

What to Include

- **Walkability/proximity:** specific distances to specific places — coffee shop, park, school, train. Never “near everything.”
- **Commute reality:** be honest and exact. “22 minutes to downtown” is real. “Convenient location” is noise.
- **Community feel:** what does the street feel like on a Saturday afternoon?
- **Schools:** if they’re strong, name them. If they’re not a selling point, skip them — don’t lie.

Three to four sentences. Enough to establish context. Not so much that it competes with the home.

Part 5: The Call to Action

Soft Sells That Create Urgency Without Desperation

The CTA is where agents either go silent or go catastrophic.

Skip it, and you leave the buyer with no direction — they’ve read something compelling and then... nothing. Panic-sell it, and you destroy everything you built. “DON’T WAIT — THIS WON’T LAST!” is the real estate equivalent of “this deal is only good today.” It signals fear, not confidence.

The right CTA creates a natural next step, respects the buyer’s intelligence, and leverages *real* urgency — market conditions, timing, uniqueness — without manufactured pressure.

✗ **Desperate:** > *“Won’t last! Schedule your showing TODAY before it’s gone! Call now!!”*

Every punctuation mark subtracts credibility.

✓ **Confident:** > *“Properties like this — turnkey, this location, this condition — don’t accumulate days on market. Showings begin Thursday. Offers reviewed Sunday.”*

✓ **Confident (unique/premium listing):** > *“There’s exactly one of this. If you’ve been waiting for the right one, this is a good time to stop waiting.”*

✓ **Confident (low-pressure):** > *“Come see it in person — the photos do well, but the spaces do better. Schedule a private showing at the link above.”*

Two sentences is enough. The job is simple: tell the buyer what to do next, and give them one good reason to do it.

Length, Tone, and Format: MLS vs. Social vs. Ads

The same property needs different versions of its story depending on where the copy lives. Using identical text everywhere is wearing a suit to the beach and a swimsuit to the office — same person, wrong

context.

Format	Length	Tone	Primary Goal
MLS Description	250-500 words	Informative + evocative	Earn the showing
Social Caption	80-150 words	Conversational, punchy	Stop the scroll, drive DMs
Digital Ad Copy	25-50 words	Urgent, benefit-led	Drive clicks
Email to Buyer List	150-250 words	Personal, story-forward	Create qualified interest
Flyer/Print	100-200 words	Polished, scannable	Support in-person visits

MLS: earn the showing. Complete enough that a buyer decides to schedule — not so complete they feel they’ve already seen it. Lead with feeling, deliver the facts, close with urgency. Use the full 5-part structure.

Social: hook in the first line. Most platforms collapse text behind “read more,” so your strongest hook goes first. Skip the feature list — send them to the MLS for that. Social’s job is desire, not details.

Instagram example: “A home that somehow feels bigger every time you walk in. Kitchen opens to the yard. Basement’s ready for whatever you’ve been putting off. Showings start Thursday — link in bio.”

Ads: one benefit, one click. 25-50 words, sometimes less. Pick one vivid benefit and drive the click. No adjectives, no feature lists, no “welcome to.”

Ad example: “3 beds. Finished basement. Half a mile from the park. The kind of move-up home that doesn’t stay listed long. Schedule a showing →”

The Fully Annotated Example

A complete listing — every section broken down so you can see exactly what’s happening and why.

Property: 4-bed, 2.5-bath craftsman in a walkable neighborhood. Likely buyer: young family. Asking: \$485,000.

“Three years ago, the sellers almost didn’t put in an offer — the commute felt like a stretch. Today, they’d tell you it’s the best decision they ever made.”

What this does: Opens with a story, not a spec. Creates social proof. Raises a question (*what changed?*) that pulls the buyer forward. Triggers Belonging.

“Mornings here have a rhythm: coffee at the island while the kids eat, light coming through the east-facing windows, everyone out the door without a collision. Weekends stretch

differently — the backyard is big enough to matter, the neighborhood is quiet enough to hear it.”

What this does: The lifestyle paragraph. A specific day-in-the-life preview across two moments — weekday morning and weekend. Paints the buyer *in* the home rather than the home in isolation. No room names; only experiences.

“The kitchen was renovated two years ago — quartz counters, a gas range that means business, and an island that earns its space. The primary suite gets the quiet end of the house and a walk-in closet that finally makes the ‘we need more storage’ conversation irrelevant. Original hardwood floors throughout the main level. The finished basement adds 600 square feet of flex space — currently a playroom, but the layout supports a home office, gym, or guest suite with no renovation required.”

What this does: The translation layer. Four features — kitchen, primary suite, hardwoods, basement — each run through at least one layer of FBF. “An island that earns its space” = benefit. “Makes the storage conversation irrelevant” = feeling. Note: no “spacious,” no “stunning,” anywhere.

“Millbrook is the kind of neighborhood that makes the commute math worth running. Six blocks to Jefferson Elementary, four minutes to the highway, and a Saturday farmers market that’s been there longer than most of the houses. The kind of block where neighbors still wave, and new ones get welcomed.”

What this does: Neighborhood and context. Specific distances to specific things. Community feel without cheese. “Commute math worth running” ties back to the opening story.

“Turnkey homes in this condition, at this price point, in Millbrook, don’t accumulate days on market. Showings begin Thursday. Offers reviewed Sunday evening.”

What this does: The CTA. Market-grounded urgency — specific and credible. A clear timeline. No exclamation marks. No begging. Confidence.

The full listing, assembled:

Three years ago, the sellers almost didn’t put in an offer — the commute felt like a stretch. Today, they’d tell you it’s the best decision they ever made.

Mornings here have a rhythm: coffee at the island while the kids eat, light coming through the east-facing windows, everyone out the door without a collision. Weekends stretch differently — the backyard is big enough to matter, the neighborhood is quiet enough to hear it.

The kitchen was renovated two years ago — quartz counters, a gas range that means business, and an island that earns its space. The primary suite gets the quiet end of the house and a walk-in closet that finally makes the “we need more storage” conversation irrelevant. Original hardwood floors throughout the main level. The finished basement adds 600 square feet of flex space — currently a playroom, but the layout supports a home office, gym, or guest suite with no renovation required.

Millbrook is the kind of neighborhood that makes the commute math worth running. Six blocks to Jefferson Elementary, four minutes to the highway, and a Saturday farmers market that's been there longer than most of the houses. The kind of block where neighbors still wave, and new ones get welcomed.

Turnkey homes in this condition, at this price point, in Millbrook, don't accumulate days on market. Showings begin Thursday. Offers reviewed Sunday evening.

Word count: 271. Every one of them working.

Before/After: Full Listing Comparison

Before — a real (bad) listing:

"Welcome to this beautiful 4-bedroom, 2.5-bath home in Millbrook! This move-in ready gem features an updated kitchen with quartz countertops and stainless appliances, hardwood floors on the main level, large primary suite with walk-in closet, finished basement, and a lovely backyard. Two-car garage. Located near top-rated schools and convenient to shopping and dining. Don't miss your chance to own this stunning property — schedule your showing today!"

78 words. Zero images created. Five clichés in three sentences.

After: See the annotated example above.

The rewrite is 271 words — longer, yes, but every word has a job. More importantly: the before version could describe 40% of the listings on your MLS right now. The after version could describe exactly one home on earth.

That's the difference.

Chapter Summary

- High-converting listings follow a 5-part structure: **Hook, Lifestyle Paragraph, Feature Translation, Neighborhood & Context, CTA.**
- The hook has one job: make the buyer feel something that earns the next sentence.
- The lifestyle paragraph sells the *experience* of living there — not the specs.
- Run FBF to translate every major feature from a fact into a feeling.
- The neighborhood section places the buyer in the home's life radius — specifics, never vague claims.
- The CTA creates urgency grounded in reality. A timeline and a credible reason are all you need.
- MLS, social, and ads are three different formats requiring three different versions. Same story. Different lens.

Coming up in Chapter 3: Structure gets you a great listing. But the best copy in the world lands flat when it's written for the wrong buyer. Next: the buyer profiling system — so before you

write a single word, you know exactly who's reading, what triggers them, and how to make them feel this listing was written specifically for them. Because it will be.

— End of Chapter 2 —

CHAPTER 3

Buyer Psychology by Property Type

How to Match Your Copy to Your Buyer

The description that converts a first-time buyer will bore an investor. The copy that thrills a luxury buyer will land tone-deaf on a downsizer. The most expensive mistake in listing marketing is writing for *yourself* — using language you like, features you find impressive, adjectives that sound good in your own head.

Real estate copy isn't about how you feel about the property. It's about who's reading — and what they're trying to become.

From Chapter 1, the four triggers that drive every real estate decision:

- **Belonging** — *I fit here. This is my place, my people.*
- **Status** — *This home says something about who I am.*
- **Safety** — *I won't get this wrong. I'm protected.*
- **Urgency** — *If I don't move now, I lose something I want.*

Every buyer type weights these triggers differently. Some need Safety first. Some lead with Status. Some want numbers; some want a feeling. Your job is to know which levers to pull — *before* you write a word.

This chapter is the complete playbook for six buyer profiles. Study it. Bookmark it. Open it every time you sit down to write.

Buyer Type 1: First-Time Buyers

What They're Really Buying

First-time buyers aren't buying a property. They're buying **proof that they made it**. Homeownership carries enormous emotional weight — stability, adulthood, roots. The house is almost secondary to the feeling of crossing the threshold.

But underneath the excitement runs a current of fear. They don't know what they don't know. They've heard the horror stories — bad inspections, hidden repairs, buying at the wrong time. They want to believe this is the right move, and they're reading the listing itself for permission to want it.

Primary Trigger: Safety. Secondary: Belonging.

Safety dominates. First-timers need to feel they're not walking into a trap. Language signaling stability, move-in readiness, and low-friction ownership lowers their anxiety and moves them to act. Belonging comes second — they need to picture themselves in the neighborhood, the kitchen, the life.

Language to Use

- "Move-in ready" — removes the fear of hidden work
- "Updated," "new," "recently replaced" — they won't inherit problems
- "Quiet street," "established neighborhood," "walkable to..." — community signals
- "Low-maintenance" — lowers perceived risk
- "Perfect for first-time buyers" — explicit permission to see themselves here
- Concrete details: square footage, HOA status, school district by name

Language to Avoid

- "As-is" — alarm bells
- "Needs TLC," "investor special" — reads as a trap
- "Priced to move" — makes them worry they're missing something
- "Motivated seller" — implies something is wrong
- Technical talk about zoning, easements, lot splits

Sample Copy

This bright 3-bedroom ranch sits on a quiet cul-de-sac in the award-winning Ridgeline School District. The kitchen was fully updated in 2022 — new cabinets, countertops, and appliances — so you're moving in, not moving in to work. First-time buyers especially appreciate the low-maintenance yard and the attached two-car garage. This one's genuinely ready for you.

Buyer Type 2: Move-Up Buyers

What They're Really Buying

Move-up buyers already own a home. They know how this works. What they're buying is an **identity upgrade** — more space, yes, but more importantly, a statement about where they've arrived. The new neighborhood matters as much as the new square footage. So does the kitchen, the primary suite, the address.

These buyers are trading one version of themselves for a better one. Your listing should make them feel like they've leveled up.

Primary Trigger: Status. Secondary: Belonging.

Status is the engine. The home must feel like an *elevation* — not just bigger, better. Belonging matters because they're also buying into a new neighborhood identity: the right school, the right neighbors, the right signal to the people in their life.

Language to Use

- “Entertainer’s kitchen,” “chef’s kitchen” — performance and status
- “Primary suite retreat,” “spa bath” — luxury elevation
- “Sought-after neighborhood,” “top-rated schools” — social proof
- “Upgraded,” “designer,” “custom” — intentional choices, not builder-grade
- Street and neighborhood names, when the address carries weight
- Amenities that imply lifestyle: golf, restaurants, trails

Language to Avoid

- “Cozy” — reads as small; they’re done with small
- “Functional” — too neutral; they want elevated
- “Great value” — undercuts the status signal
- “Starter home” — obviously
- Generic neighborhood references with no weight

Sample Copy

Situated on one of Westfield’s most recognized streets, this updated 4-bedroom home was redesigned for people who entertain and live well. The open-concept main floor connects a chef’s kitchen — waterfall island, Thermador range, butler’s pantry — to a great room that actually holds a crowd. The primary suite is its own wing. This is the house you’ve been working toward.

Buyer Type 3: Downsizers

What They’re Really Buying

Downsizers have lived in the big house. They raised kids there, hosted the holidays, accumulated decades of stuff. Now they’re choosing differently — not because they failed, but because they’ve **arrived**. The smaller home represents freedom, not loss.

The emotional dynamic is subtle. They’re letting go of something that holds identity. Your copy must honor what they’re leaving while making the next chapter feel like a reward — never a consolation prize.

Primary Trigger: Safety. Secondary: Status (reframed as freedom).

Safety drives the decision — this must feel like the *smart* move, not a downgrade. Status gets reframed: the luxury of less, the intelligence of simplicity. A smaller, better home carries its own status when framed correctly.

Language to Use

- “Low-maintenance,” “lock-and-leave,” “single-level” — practical freedom

- “Thoughtfully designed” — quality over quantity
- “Right-sized” — always better than “smaller”
- “Resort-style community,” “active adult” (when appropriate)
- “Close to...” — doctors, grocery, culture matter here
- Lead with finishes and quality, never square footage

Language to Avoid

- “Downsizing” itself — they know; don’t remind them
- Anything emphasizing what’s missing over what’s present
- “Starter” anything
- Youth-coded language (“perfect for young families,” “great for kids”)
- Square footage comparisons

Sample Copy

No stairs. No yard maintenance. No wasted rooms. This single-level 2-bedroom in the gated Harborview community was designed for the way you want to live now — high-end finishes, a covered patio, and a layout that’s easy on both the schedule and the knees. Lock up and leave whenever you want. The house takes care of itself.

Buyer Type 4: Investors

What They’re Really Buying

Investors speak in cap rates and cash-on-cash return. They want numbers, comps, rent history. But here’s what most agents miss: **investors are still emotional buyers.** They’re buying the feeling of being smart — of building wealth, of making the move others didn’t see.

Write to both the analytical mind and the ego underneath it.

Primary Trigger: Urgency. Secondary: Status (being the smart money).

Urgency matters because investors are opportunity-driven — they need to believe the deal vanishes if they hesitate. Status matters because the savvy-investor identity is real; they want to feel like they’re seeing what others are missing.

Language to Use

- Actual numbers: rent estimates, cap rate, price per square foot, ARV
- “Proven rental market,” “high-demand corridor”
- “Value-add opportunity” — signals upside without screaming “needs work”
- “Currently rented at \$X,” “long-term tenant in place”
- “Below market” — only if true and defensible
- Demand drivers: employers, universities, transit
- “Immediate cash flow,” “day-one income”

Language to Avoid

- Lifestyle language without data behind it
- “Charming,” “cozy,” “one-of-a-kind” without context
- Emotional neighborhood narrative without demand signals
- Vague “potential” with no supporting logic

Sample Copy

Currently generating \$2,100/month with a long-term tenant in place, this 3-bed/2-bath in the Central District sits three blocks from the MetroLink station and half a mile from Regional Medical. Rents in this zip have climbed 11% over the past 24 months. The property is clean, cash-flowing, and ready to transfer. For an investor with a 1031 window, this one closes the gap.

Buyer Type 5: Luxury Buyers

What They’re Really Buying

Luxury buyers are buying an **experience — and a signal**. The home tells a story about who they are, to themselves and to others. At this price point, features are assumed. What’s being evaluated is taste, rarity, and exclusivity. They want to feel they discovered something not available to everyone.

The trap agents fall into: saying too much. Every feature, every upgrade, every appliance. Luxury buyers are repelled by desperation and bored by laundry lists. They respond to **restraint**.

Primary Trigger: Status. Secondary: Belonging (to a rare group).

But a specific kind of status. Not “look at all this stuff.” Rather: *“This exists. Very few people will ever live here.”* Belonging operates as exclusivity — the sense that this home is for a certain kind of person, and that person is them.

Language to Use

- Architecture and provenance: “hand-hewn oak,” “Venetian plaster,” “Boffi kitchen”
- Understated but exact: “1.4 acres of complete privacy”
- Scarcity signals: “one of six,” “rarely available,” “the last lot of its kind”
- The experience, not the spec sheet: “wakes up to mountain views,” “hosts without effort”
- Named architects and designers, when relevant
- Short sentences. Confidence doesn’t qualify itself.

Language to Avoid

- “Luxury” itself — if you have to say it, you don’t have it
- Exclamation points. Ever.

- Stacked adjectives: “stunning, breathtaking, magnificent”
- Feature dumps: 27 upgrades in sequence
- “Motivated seller” — catastrophic at this price point
- Approximations: “4,600 sq ft,” never “approximately 4,600 sq ft”

Sample Copy

Set behind a private gate on two acres at the end of a canyon road, this four-bedroom residence was designed by Studio North in collaboration with the land — not imposed on it. Every room frames a specific view. The kitchen is Boffi. The primary wing is its own structure. There are no neighbors in sight. Properties like this don’t come back.

Buyer Type 6: Remote Workers / Lifestyle Buyers

What They’re Really Buying

This buyer emerged from a permanent shift in how people work — and they’ve permanently changed what “location” means. The remote/lifestyle buyer isn’t moving to a city for a job. They’re moving to a **place for a life**. The home is headquarters, gym, office, and reset button.

They’re buying flexibility. Working from anywhere made them realize they never chose where they lived. Now they’re choosing — and they want the home and the town to reflect that choice back at them.

Primary Trigger: Belonging. Secondary: Safety (smart decision).

Belonging dominates: they need to see themselves in the lifestyle this home and place enable. Safety follows — relocation is a big decision, and they need to feel they’ve thought it through, not just escaped. Make both the home and the location feel intentional and intelligent.

Language to Use

- “Dedicated office,” “bonus room,” “separate workspace” — the home must work
- Internet specifics: “fiber available,” “gigabit connectivity” — non-negotiable
- “Minutes from...” — trails, ski, lakes, restaurants
- Location-as-lifestyle: “live in the mountains without giving up the city”
- “Work from home” — directly; they’re not embarrassed by it
- Outdoor access, walkability, proximity to nature
- Community fit: “vibrant arts scene,” “growing remote-worker community”

Language to Avoid

- Commute framing: “easy freeway access,” “minutes to downtown office core”

- Urban density signals without lifestyle context
- No mention of internet or workspace — a red flag by omission
- “Investment opportunity” framing — they’re not here for that

Sample Copy

The dedicated home office has its own entrance and fiber-ready connectivity — set it up once and never think about it again.

Outside the back door: 40 miles of trails, a ski resort 18 minutes away, and a mountain town that actually has things to do. The rest of the country is working from home. You’d be working from here.

Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

Buyer Type	Primary Trigger	Secondary Trigger	Tone	Key Phrases
First-Time Buyers	Safety	Belonging	Warm, reassuring, clear	Move-in ready, updated, quiet street, low-maintenance
Move-Up Buyers	Status	Belonging	Confident, aspirational	Chef’s kitchen, primary suite, sought-after designer
Downsizers	Safety	Status (as freedom)	Liberating, quality-focused	Low-maintenance lock-and-leave, right-sized, single level
Investors	Urgency	Status (smart money)	Direct, data-driven	Cap rate, cash-flow, below market, value-add, ARV
Luxury Buyers	Status	Belonging (exclusive)	Restrained, precise, confident	Rare, private, [brand names], designed by [name], never available
Remote/Lifestyle Buyers	Belonging	Safety	Energetic, location-rich	Dedicated office, fiber, minutes from, world from here

Chapter Summary

Most listing copy fails at the first sentence — not because the writing is bad, but because it's aimed at the wrong person.

Every buyer type carries a distinct emotional profile. First-timers need Safety before anything else. Move-up buyers want the Status signal. Downsizers respond to the freedom narrative, not the feature count. Investors need hard numbers with urgency underneath. Luxury buyers want restraint and rarity. Remote workers are buying a lifestyle headquarters — and a place that chose them back.

Identify your most likely buyer *before* you write, and you shift from describing a property to speaking directly to one person's desires and fears. That's when copy converts.

The four triggers — Belonging, Status, Safety, Urgency — run through every profile. But they're weighted differently, activated differently, and expressed in entirely different language. Now you have the map.

Your action step: Before your next listing, name the primary buyer profile. Choose your dominant trigger. Then write the first paragraph with that buyer in your head — not the property in front of you.

Up next — Chapter 4: The ListWorks Formula. You understand the emotional architecture. You know your buyer. Now we build the machine: the exact framework for high-converting MLS descriptions in under 15 minutes — the opening-hook formula, feature sequencing for emotional impact, the closing line that creates urgency without desperation, and how one set of property notes feeds social captions, ad headlines, and email subject lines. One framework. Every surface. Every listing.

— End of Chapter 3 —

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CHAPTER 5

The 90-Second Listing Workflow

Blank page to polished, publish-ready copy — faster than most agents find the right adjective.

Let's get something out of the way.

When you tell other agents you can write a full listing package in 90 seconds — MLS description, social caption, ad headlines, all of it — they'll look at you like you said you commute by jet pack.

Let them look.

By the end of this chapter, you'll have a repeatable system that produces better copy than most agents write in an hour of staring at a blank screen. You'll use it on every listing. You'll wonder what you

were doing before. And occasionally — if you’re the type — you’ll quietly enjoy watching someone spend forty-five minutes on a description while you’re already on to the next thing.

This is the chapter you’ll come back to. Bookmark it. Print it. Tape it above your monitor.

How the System Works (The 30-Second Overview)

Four steps. Always in sequence. Never changes.

STEP 1 → Fill Your Property Input Sheet	(~60 seconds)
STEP 2 → Run Your Master Prompt	(~10 seconds)
STEP 3 → Review and Personalize	(~20 seconds)
STEP 4 → Export to Formats	(~10 seconds)

TOTAL: ~100 seconds

The magic isn’t in any single step — it’s in the combination: a structured input that gives the AI everything it needs, a battle-tested prompt that tells it exactly what to do, and a review step short enough that you’ll actually do it instead of skipping it.

Walk through each step once. After that, it’s muscle memory.

STEP 1 — Fill Out Your Property Input Sheet

The 60-second setup that makes everything else possible

The Property Input Sheet is the foundation of the entire system: a twelve-field template you fill out *before* touching any AI tool. Think of it as a creative brief. You’re not writing copy yet — you’re organizing the raw material the AI will transform into copy.

This matters because **AI is exactly as good as what you feed it**. Vague input produces vague output. Specific, structured input — even a fast one — produces copy that sounds like you knew what you were doing.

📄 THE PROPERTY INPUT SHEET

PROPERTY INPUT SHEET

- PROPERTY TYPE:
☐ Single family ☐ Condo/townhome ☐ New construction
☐ Multi-family ☐ Fixer/investment ☐ Luxury
- LOCATION SNAPSHOT:
Neighborhood name: _____
One sentence on why people want to live there:

Walkability/proximity note (coffee, schools, trails, transit):

3. THE THREE BEST THINGS ABOUT THIS PROPERTY:

(Not beds/baths – the things that made you stop and say "oh, nice")

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

4. THE BUYER:

Who is most likely to buy this home?

(young family, first-timer, downsizer, investor, remote worker)

What do they care about most? _____

5. LIFESTYLE THIS HOME ENABLES:

Complete the sentence: "This home is for someone who wants to _____"

6. THE FEATURE TRANSLATION LIST:

Up to 5 features – answer "so what?" for each:

- | | | | |
|------------|-------|------------|-------|
| Feature 1: | _____ | → So what? | _____ |
| Feature 2: | _____ | → So what? | _____ |
| Feature 3: | _____ | → So what? | _____ |
| Feature 4: | _____ | → So what? | _____ |
| Feature 5: | _____ | → So what? | _____ |

7. THE ONE THING:

If a buyer remembered ONE thing about this listing, what should it be?

8. WHAT TO AVOID / SENSITIVE NOTES:

Anything to NOT mention? Angle to avoid? Seller preference?

9. PRICE RANGE / MARKET CONTEXT: (optional)

10. COMPARABLE LIFESTYLE / FEEL: (optional)

"The vibe of this home is like _____"

(e.g., "a restored craftsman in a coffee-shop neighborhood,"

"a luxury retreat that never feels showy")

11. TONE DIRECTION:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Warm and personal | ☐ Sharp and confident |
| ☐ Sophisticated/quiet | ☐ Energetic/aspirational |
| ☐ Straightforward/honest | |

12. EXTRA NOTES:

Anything else the AI should know? _____

How to Fill It Fast

You already know this property. You walked it. You talked to the sellers. You know the neighborhood. The Input Sheet isn't asking you to research — it's asking you to *organize what's already in your head*.

After the first few runs, most agents fill it in 60 seconds. The fields that carry the most weight:

- **Field 3 (Three best things):** Be ruthless about specificity. Not “updated kitchen” — “waterfall quartz island that seats four.” Not “nice backyard” — “fully fenced with a new Trex deck and lights already strung.”
- **Field 4 (The buyer):** The single most important creative decision in the whole system. Everything downstream changes based on this answer.
- **Field 5 (The lifestyle):** Finish the sentence with your gut answer. Your gut is usually right.
- **Field 7 (The one thing):** If you can’t answer this, the listing doesn’t have a story yet. Find the story before you prompt.

What to skip: Fields 9 and 10 unless they’re obviously relevant. Don’t overthink Field 12. The goal is *organized*, not exhaustive.

STEP 2 — Run Your Master Prompt

Paste. Send. Done.

This is where the system earns its name.

The Master Prompt is a pre-written, pre-tested instruction set you paste into your AI tool every single time — with your completed Input Sheet dropped in at the designated spot. You don’t rewrite it. You don’t tweak it per listing. Paste, insert, send.

THE LISTWORKS MASTER PROMPT

You are a professional real estate copywriter specializing in high-converting listing descriptions. Your writing is confident, specific, and emotionally resonant — it makes buyers feel something, then gives them the facts to justify that feeling.

You do not use filler phrases like “Welcome to,” “Don’t miss out,” “Must see,” “Spacious,” “Cozy,” or “Motivated seller.” You write in clear, vivid, buyer-psychology-driven language that stops the scroll.

Using the property information below, generate a complete listing marketing package with the following four components:

-
1. **MLS DESCRIPTION (200–250 words)**
 - Open with a scroll-stopping first sentence (no “Welcome to”)
 - Use the Feature → Benefit → Feeling framework throughout
 - Activate at least one emotional trigger: Belonging, Status, Safety, or Urgency
 - Close with a soft, confident call to action
 - No bullet points — flowing, readable paragraphs
 2. **INSTAGRAM CAPTION (100–130 words + hashtags)**
 - Open with a hook line that works without an image
 - Conversational and warm — personal, not promotional
 - End with a question or CTA that invites engagement

- Include 15 targeted hashtags on a separate line
3. FACEBOOK POST (150–180 words)
 - Slightly longer form, story-driven
 - Speak to the lifestyle, not just the property
 - End with a clear, low-pressure CTA (schedule a tour, DM for info, etc.)
 4. AD HEADLINE SET (3 variations)
 - Each headline under 10 words
 - One leads with emotion, one with specificity, one with urgency
 - Suitable for Facebook/Instagram paid ads or Google Display
-

PROPERTY INFORMATION:
[PASTE YOUR COMPLETED PROPERTY INPUT SHEET HERE]

Write all four components now. Do not add commentary, explanations, or notes between sections – just the copy, clearly labeled.

Where to Run It

The Master Prompt works in any major AI tool:

- **ChatGPT (GPT-4o or higher)** — paste directly into a new conversation
- **Claude (Sonnet or Opus)** — exceptionally strong with structured prompts like this
- **Gemini Advanced** — solid, especially for local/neighborhood flavor
- **Copilot (Microsoft 365)** — fine if you live in the Microsoft ecosystem

Pro move: Save the Master Prompt as a snippet or keyboard shortcut so you never hunt for it. On Mac: TextExpander, Alfred, or built-in Text Replacement. On Windows: AutoHotkey or AutoCorrect shortcuts. One keystroke drops the entire prompt into any text field in under a second.

STEP 3 — Review and Personalize

The 20 seconds that make AI copy sound human

The truth about AI-generated copy: it's 85% of the way there on the first pass. The remaining 15% is what separates a great listing from a generic one — and closing that gap takes about 20 seconds.

This is not a rewrite. It's a targeted scan with three specific checkpoints.

The 20-Second Review Protocol

Read the MLS description once, quickly. Check:

① **The Fingerprint Word** Drop in one word, phrase, or detail that's distinctly *yours* — somewhere in the first paragraph. A single adjective with your voice in it. A neighborhood detail only a local would know. A line about the sellers that gives the listing a heartbeat.

This is what makes AI copy feel like you wrote it. Five seconds. Changes everything.

② **The Banned Words Check** Scan and replace on sight: - *Spacious* → describe what fits there - *Cozy* → own it or reframe it - *Updated* → specify the update - *Beautiful / Stunning* → show why; don't tell it - *Amazing* → never - *Rare opportunity* → prove rarity with specifics - *Won't last long* → only with market data behind it

AI is trained on millions of listings that use these words constantly. They *will* sneak in. Catch them. (Full banned list in the appendix.)

③ **The Truthfulness Check** Confirm nothing overstates, misrepresents, or implies something the property can't deliver. AI occasionally invents specifics or borrows language from similar properties. Read once for accuracy — every time.

If it passes all three — and most outputs will — you're done. Ship it.

When to Actually Rewrite

Sometimes the output needs more than a tweak. Fine. Here's how to fix it without starting over:

- **Wrong tone?** Add one line and re-run: *"Rewrite the MLS description only, with a warmer, more personal tone. The buyer is a young family, not a luxury buyer."*
- **Weak opening?** Re-run just the lead: *"Give me 5 alternative opening sentences for this listing. They should stop the scroll and activate the feeling of belonging."*
- **Too generic?** You undersold the Input Sheet. Add specificity to Fields 3, 5, and 7 and re-run.

The golden rule: If you're rewriting more than 20% of the output, the Input Sheet needed more detail — not the prompt.

STEP 4 — Export to Formats

One input. Four ready-to-use outputs.

By now your copy exists. Step 4 just moves it where it needs to go.

Output 1 — MLS Description. Copy into your MLS field. Watch the character limit (most systems cap at 1,000–2,500 characters). If it runs long: *"Shorten this MLS description to under 1,000 characters without losing the opening hook or the emotional tone."*

Output 2 — Instagram Caption. Copy into your scheduler (Later, Buffer, Planoly) or post directly. Hashtags are included — move them to the first comment if you prefer a cleaner look.

Output 3 — Facebook Post. Post directly or schedule. Add the listing photos after posting.

Output 4 — Ad Headlines. Save them in a running doc (Google Doc or Notion). When you're ready to run paid ads, your headline set is already written. A/B test the three variations and let performance data decide which framing wins.

The Delivery Stack

```
📁 [Street Address] – Listing Package
├── MLS_Description.txt
├── Instagram_Caption.txt
├── Facebook_Post.txt
├── Ad_Headlines.txt
└── (Optional) → Send to True North Graphics
    for designed social graphics + flyer layout
```

On the ListWorks subscription, this entire package arrives as a formatted PDF — ready for your sellers, your team, or your brokerage. No file management required.

The Full 90-Second Walkthrough

Let's run the system live.

The Property: 3-bed, 2-bath ranch in a walkable neighborhood. New kitchen, original hardwoods, covered patio, two blocks from a popular trail system. Likely buyer: couple, late 30s, upgrading from a condo. Primary appeal: outdoor lifestyle + turnkey condition.

Input Sheet (filled in 55 seconds):

1. PROPERTY TYPE: Single family
2. LOCATION: Mapleton Hill – coffee shops, trailhead 2 blocks, walkable to everything
3. THREE BEST THINGS:
 - Completely redone kitchen with quartz and gas range
 - Original hardwood floors throughout (immaculate)
 - Covered patio backing to a quiet alley – very private
4. THE BUYER: Late-30s couple, upgrading from condo. Want space, outdoor access, no projects.
5. LIFESTYLE: "This home is for someone who wants to be outside more – without giving up a great kitchen."
6. FEATURE TRANSLATIONS:
 - New kitchen → they can actually cook now, not work around limitations
 - Hardwoods → original character without the renovation timeline
 - Covered patio → outdoor living that works in the rain
 - Trail access → Saturday morning runs start at the front door
7. THE ONE THING: Turnkey outdoor-lifestyle home – rare at this price
8. NOTHING TO AVOID
11. TONE: Sharp and confident

Prompt sent: Master Prompt + Input Sheet pasted. Send. (8 seconds.)

Output received (MLS Description):

Some homes make you want to stay inside. This isn't one of them.

Set two blocks from the trailhead in Mapleton Hill, this three-bedroom ranch was made for the buyer who wants to be outside more — without giving anything up to get there. The kitchen was fully redone with quartz countertops, a gas range that means business, and enough counter space to actually use it. The original hardwood floors run through every room, warm and immaculate in the way that only the real thing manages to be. And out back, a covered patio opens onto a quiet alley — private enough to feel like yours, comfortable enough to use in April.

Three bedrooms. Two full baths. No projects waiting. Just a home that's ready to go, in a neighborhood that already is.

Showings start Saturday. This price point in Mapleton Hill doesn't stay patient.

(Generated in 9 seconds.)

Review (20-second check): - ✓ No banned words - ✓ First sentence stops the scroll - ✓ Truthful — nothing overstated - ✓ One local touch added (“April” — a nod to Colorado spring weather) → fingerprint applied

Total time, start to finish: 92 seconds.

Why This Works (And Why It Keeps Working)

The 90-Second Workflow isn't a hack. It's a **leverage system**.

You bring what AI can't: the walk-through, the intuition, the neighborhood knowledge, the relationship with the sellers, the read on the buyer. You know things about that property that will never appear in a data sheet.

The AI brings what you shouldn't have to: blank-page discipline, structural consistency, and the ability to write four formats simultaneously without any of them degrading.

Together — your input, its output, your 20-second review — you produce better copy than either of you could alone. Every time. In 90 seconds.

The agents who understand this first will look like they have a staff of copywriters. They won't. They'll just have this.

Chapter Summary

- The workflow has four steps: **Input Sheet → Master Prompt → Review → Export**.
- The Property Input Sheet is a 12-field template that organizes what you already know.
- The Master Prompt is permanent — paste it every time, never rewrite it.

- The 20-second review has three checkpoints: **Fingerprint Word, Banned Words, Truthfulness.**
- One input produces four outputs: MLS description, Instagram caption, Facebook post, ad headlines.
- The system works because you supply the intelligence; the AI supplies the execution.

Coming up in Chapter 6: The full ListWorks Prompt Library — every specialized prompt for luxury listings, fixer-uppers, investment properties, new construction, open houses, and the hardest listings of all: the ones with nothing obvious to say.

— End of Chapter 5 —

BONUS SECTION

The AI-Powered Real Estate Writing System

ListWorks / Exclusive Buyer Bonuses

BONUS 1 — The Quick-Win Prompt Pack

10 Ready-to-Fire AI Prompts for the Situations Agents Dread Most

These prompts are copy-paste ready. Drop them into ChatGPT, Claude, or any AI writing tool exactly as written, fill in the brackets, and send. Each one is engineered to deliver something usable on the first try.

Prompt 1: “I have nothing good to say about this property.”

You are a real estate copywriter. I’m listing a home that is modest — [brief description: small lot, older finishes, busy street, etc.] — and I’m struggling to write compelling copy without overpromising. Your job is to find the genuine angle: what buyer would love this home, and why? Write a 100-word MLS description that leads with the strongest honest benefit, speaks directly to that buyer, and doesn’t apologize for what the home is. Do not use filler words like “charming,” “cozy,” or “nestled.” Be specific and confident.

Prompt 2: “The seller is unrealistic about what the home offers.”

You are a real estate copywriter helping me navigate a sensitive listing. The seller believes their home is exceptional because [reason: they renovated the kitchen themselves, it’s in a “great”

location, they raised their family there]. In reality, the home is [honest description]. Write a 120-word MLS description that honors what the home genuinely offers without fabricating value. Focus on tangible features — square footage, lot size, layout, proximity to [specific location detail]. The goal is to attract a realistic buyer, not set false expectations. Avoid emotional language the seller might expect but buyers won't trust.

Prompt 3: "I need to relaunch a stale listing that's sat 60+ days."

You are a real estate copywriter tasked with relaunching a listing that has been on market for [X] days without selling. The current description reads: "[paste existing copy]." Rewrite it from scratch — new angle, new lead, new energy. Do not recycle the same opening or the same feature order. If the price has been reduced, lead with the value story, not the reduction. Write 120 words for MLS and a separate 3-sentence social media caption framed as "newly positioned" or "back in the spotlight." Avoid anything that signals the listing is stale.

Prompt 4: "I'm listing in a neighborhood I don't know well."

You are a real estate copywriter. I'm listing a property at [address or cross streets] in [city/neighborhood], and I'm not deeply familiar with the area. Here are the home's features: [list key specs — beds, baths, sq ft, notable upgrades]. Write a 120-word MLS description that focuses primarily on the property's physical strengths rather than neighborhood claims I can't verify. Where neighborhood context helps, use only general, verifiable language — school district name, proximity to downtown, major nearby road or landmark. Do not invent lifestyle claims. Make the home itself the hero.

Prompt 5: "The photos are bad but the home is genuinely great."

You are a real estate copywriter. The listing photos for this property are poor quality and won't do the home justice, so the description must carry extra weight. The home's genuine strengths: [list 4-6 specific features — vaulted ceilings, original hardwood, oversized lot, updated bathrooms]. Write a 130-word MLS description so specific and vivid that a buyer can picture the space clearly without relying on the photos. Use precise measurements, materials, and details wherever possible. The goal is to get buyers through the door in spite of the images — not because of them.

Prompt 6: "I need a price reduction announcement that doesn't feel like defeat."

You are a real estate copywriter. I need to announce a price adjustment on a listing — the new price is [price], down from [original price]. Do not frame this as a correction or a problem. Write a 3-4 sentence social media post and a 2-sentence email

subject line + opening that positions this as a strategic opportunity for the right buyer. Emphasize what the buyer gets at the new price point, not what changed. Use confident, forward-looking language. Do not use the words “reduced,” “dropped,” “cut,” or “lowered.” The tone should feel like the seller is opening a door, not backing down.

Prompt 7: “I need an open house invitation that actually gets people to show up.”

You are a real estate copywriter. Write an open house invitation for [property address or description] on [day, date, time]. The home’s most compelling features: [list 3 specifics]. Write two versions: (1) a social media post under 100 words with a clear call-to-action and event details, and (2) a short email invitation with a subject line, 3-sentence body, and closing line. Both should create mild urgency without being pushy. Focus on what the attendee will experience walking through the door — not the square footage. Make it feel like an event worth showing up for.

Prompt 8: “I need a Just Sold post that generates seller leads, not just likes.”

You are a real estate copywriter. I just sold a home at [address or neighborhood] and want a Just Sold post that attracts potential sellers — not just celebrates the transaction. Sale details: [list price, days on market, notable facts like multiple offers or above asking]. Write a 3-paragraph social media post. Paragraph 1: the result. Paragraph 2: what made the difference (marketing, timing, strategy — keep it specific). Paragraph 3: a direct, low-pressure invitation for neighbors or anyone thinking about selling to reach out. End with a single-line CTA. Tone: confident, not boastful.

Prompt 9: “This listing has an unusual or polarizing feature.”

You are a real estate copywriter. This listing has an unusual feature that some buyers will love and others will dismiss: [describe it — no garage, backing to a highway, converted garage, steep lot, unusual layout]. Your job is not to hide it — it’s to find and speak directly to the buyer who sees it as a feature, not a flaw. Write a 120-word MLS description that leads with genuine strengths and addresses the polarizing element honestly, framed in its best truthful light. Do not bury it at the end. The right buyer will respect the honesty. The wrong buyer was never going to make an offer anyway.

Prompt 10: “I need a listing in under 30 seconds — I’m late.”

Write a 100-word MLS listing description for a [beds]BR/[baths]BA home in [city]. Key features: [paste or list available details — sq ft, lot, garage, updates, year built]. Lead with the single strongest selling point. Use short, active sentences. No filler phrases. No generic adjectives. Deliver something I can publish immediately.

That's the whole prompt. Fast and functional. It works.

BONUS 2 — The Listing Description Checklist

Before You Hit Publish, Run This 60-Second Check

Print this page. Keep it at your desk. Run it before every listing goes live.

SECTION A: THE MUST-HAVES

Every listing you publish should have all 10.

- ☐ **1. A specific, benefit-forward opening line.** Your first sentence is your headline. It states a concrete reason to keep reading — it doesn't announce that the home exists.
- ☐ **2. At least one hard number in the first 30 words.** Square footage, lot size, ceiling height, garage capacity. Specificity signals credibility and helps buyers self-qualify.
- ☐ **3. The home's strongest feature in the first half.** Buyers skim. If your best asset is buried in sentence seven, most readers never see it.
- ☐ **4. A clear lifestyle sentence.** One line that shows what it *feels like* to live there — morning light, walkable to coffee, a backyard big enough for a garden. Ground the buyer emotionally before they tour.
- ☐ **5. All upgrades named with age or scope.** "Updated kitchen" is worthless. "Kitchen remodeled in 2022 with quartz counters and new appliances" is not.
- ☐ **6. Neighborhood or location context — at least one line.** Buyers buy location as much as house. Name the school district, a nearby landmark, the commute advantage. Something real and verifiable.
- ☐ **7. A sentence that speaks to the *right* buyer, not all buyers.** Great copy qualifies leads. If the home is perfect for a growing family, say so. If it's built for a remote worker, say that. Appealing to everyone appeals to no one.
- ☐ **8. No sentence over 25 words.** Long sentences slow readers and dilute impact. Break them up.
- ☐ **9. A closing line with momentum.** End with energy — a call to schedule, a statement about demand, or a one-line summary of the home's best case. Don't stop mid-thought.
- ☐ **10. A final proofread, out loud.** If you stumble reading it, a buyer will too. Every time, before it goes live.

SECTION B: THE NEVER-DO LIST

Any one of these is a conversion killer. Check for all 10.

- ☐ **1. Never open with the address or property type.** "Located at 123 Main Street, this 3-bedroom home..." tells buyers nothing they

- don't already know. Start with value.
- ☐ **2. Never stack more than two adjectives.** "Gorgeous, stunning, beautifully upgraded..." — buyers tune it out instantly. One precise adjective beats three generic ones.
 - ☐ **3. Never include anything you can't verify.** Guessing at the HVAC's age? Write "recently updated." Don't know the school rating? Don't quote one. A single inaccuracy poisons trust in everything else.
 - ☐ **4. Never bury the key caveat.** Busy road, small lot, HOA restriction — hiding it attracts the wrong buyer and wastes everyone's time. Honest framing is a skill. Omission is not.
 - ☐ **5. Never write "call for details" in place of an actual detail.** It reads as evasive. If you can't include something, leave it out — don't flag it as withheld.
 - ☐ **6. Never use more than one exclamation point.** One is enthusiasm. Two is noise. Three is desperation.
 - ☐ **7. Never list features in random order.** Lead with what matters most to your buyer. Interior before exterior, living areas before utility, lifestyle before logistics. Structure signals care.
 - ☐ **8. Never run past 250 words on a standard listing.** More words rarely mean more impact. Tight copy reads as confident. Dense copy reads as filler.
 - ☐ **9. Never copy-paste from a previous listing.** Even on similar homes, buyers notice boilerplate — and so does the algorithm. Fresh copy, every time.
 - ☐ **10. Never skip this checklist because you're in a hurry.** The listings that cost you most are the ones you published fast and forgot. Sixty seconds now beats a price reduction later.
-

BONUS 3 — The Banned Words List

The 40 Phrases Killing Your Listings — and What to Write Instead

Every phrase here has the same defect: it *sounds* like something and says nothing. Replace each one with what you actually mean.

CATEGORY 1: Generic Descriptors

Banned Phrase	Write Instead
Spacious	Name the actual dimensions: "18-ft living room," "1,200 sq ft main floor"
Cozy	Identify what creates the feeling: "wood-burning fireplace," "low-maintenance lot," "single-story layout"
Beautiful	Describe the feature that earns the word: "floor-to-ceiling windows," "original crown molding throughout"

Stunning	Name what's actually impressive: "unobstructed mountain views," "soaring 12-ft ceilings"
Gorgeous	Replace with the specific visual: "herringbone tile entry," "exposed brick accent wall"
Charming	Pinpoint the source: "1940s craftsman trim," "covered front porch with swing"
Lovely	Too vague to help anyone. Use a sensory or structural detail: "oak hardwood floors," "bay window with built-in bench"
Modern	Specify the update: "remodeled in 2023," "stainless appliances and quartz counters," "smart thermostat and keyless entry"
Luxurious	Justify it: "heated tile floors," "soaking tub with separate walk-in shower," "custom cabinetry throughout"
Upgraded	Name the upgrade: "new roof (2021)," "tankless water heater," "triple-pane windows"

CATEGORY 2: Weak CTAs

Banned Phrase	Write Instead
Must see!	Real urgency from facts: "Showings book fast — schedule yours before the weekend"
Don't miss out!	Make it specific: "Open house Sunday 1-3 PM — last chance before offers are reviewed"
Won't last long!	If true, show why: "Three offers in the first week on a comparable home two streets over"
Call today!	Tell them what to expect: "Schedule a private tour — available evenings and weekends"
Act fast!	Replace with a reason to act: "Seller reviewing offers [date]" or "Only [X] homes available at this price in [neighborhood]"

CATEGORY 3: Filler Openers

Banned Phrase	Write Instead
Welcome to...	Start with the home's best fact: "Vaulted ceilings, a chef's kitchen, and a backyard built for

	summer”
Nestled in...	Use the actual location detail: “Half a mile from [park/school/downtown], with easy access to [road]”
Situated in...	Same problem. Name the advantage: “In the heart of [neighborhood], walkable to [specifics]”
This home has it all	It never does. List the three things it actually has.
Look no further	Buyers already are. Tell them what to look at: “Here’s what makes this one different.”

CATEGORY 4: Overused Seller-Speak

Banned Phrase	Write Instead
Motivated seller	If true, reflect it in the price — never the copy. This phrase broadcasts desperation.
Priced to sell	Everything is priced to sell. Use: “Priced \$X below comparable homes on [street/area]”
Seller motivated	See above. Cut entirely.
Best value in the neighborhood	Prove it: “The lowest price per sq ft of any active listing in [zip code]”
Won’t find this price again	Buyers hear this constantly. Cite a real market stat instead.
Owner says sell	Destroys your negotiating position. Remove. Let the price do the talking.
Bring all offers	Fine to say privately. In public copy, it reads as a plea, not strategy.
As-is	Discloses condition without context. Frame the upside instead: “Priced for a buyer who wants to add their own finishes”
Handyman special	Honest framing wins: “Priced below market to reflect cosmetic updates needed — the bones are solid”
Estate sale	Buyers associate it with dated homes. Use only when the backstory genuinely helps the pricing context.

CATEGORY 5: Empty Value Claims

Banned Phrase	Write Instead
	Specify what makes it ready:

Move-in ready	"Fresh paint throughout, new carpet, professionally cleaned"
Turn-key	Same issue. Name what's been done: "Updated kitchen and baths, new roof, no deferred maintenance"
Rare find	Only with proof: "One of only [X] homes in [neighborhood] with a 3-car garage and no HOA"
One of a kind	Agents write this about ordinary homes. If it's genuinely unique, describe exactly how.
Perfect for entertaining	Show it: "Open-conc
